





GLOBAL CONNECT (From left) PM Modi with the Bidens in Washington, Jun. 22; with Russia's Vladimir Putin and China's Xi Jinping at a G20 summit in Osaka, 2019; with UK's Rishi Sunak at a G20 event in Bali, 2022

Q. India's digital public infrastructure of the India Stack and services such as Aadhaar, UPI, CoWIN and Pradhan Mantri Jan Dhan Yojana have been very successful in providing services directly to beneficiaries. Has India been able to showcase these as a viable development model at the G20?

Inclusive growth is the first requirement for social justice, and that needs last-mile delivery. India has shown that technology can be a great enabler to ensure last-mile delivery. The fact that 46 per cent of global digital payments transactions are now in India is a shining example of the success of our policies. The world today sees India as the incubator of innovation. Not only have global experts appreciated India's use of digital public infrastructure, but I also sense a lot of interest on it during my meetings with world leaders. India's digital public infrastructure has a diverse stack of products that find utility in both the Global South and the developed world. Many countries are interested in learning from our experience, and we have successfully initiated cooperation with at least a dozen countries. We are working with G20 countries to accelerate global development by leveraging technology, particularly promoting the concept of digital public goods through a common approach to digital public infrastructure. And this has been deeply appreciated by the G20 membership at large. We are confident that the growing popularity of India's digital public infrastructure will go a long way in accelerating global financial inclusion and ease of living.

Q. There have been discussions around using the G20 platform to help build a global start-up ecosystem. How does your government hope to move forward in this regard?

If we look at history, there has been an era of incremental growth for quite some time. But today, things have changed. From an era of incremental change, we have come to the era of disruptive innovations. The magnitude of change seen in 100 years earlier happens in just 10 years now! Governments and society have to stay abreast of the rapid changes. If we look at India's experience, we not only understood the potential of start-ups, but also provided them with a launch pad. We started the Atal Innovation Mission and the Atal Tinkering Labs. Today, there are 10,000 Atal Tinkering Labs where 7.5 million students have worked on lakhs of innovation projects. We have set up incubation centres and held numerous hackathons. This has led to the development of a mindset of 'problem-solving'.

All these interventions have led to the exponential emergence of start-ups and they are bringing about disruptive change. Today, India has around 100,000 start-ups and 100 unicorns. A lot of experts see India as the hub of start-ups. When this is our basic governance philosophy, it is natural that we want to take this momentum globally.

During India's leadership, we established the Startup20 Engagement Group, a first-of-its-kind initiative under the G20. This grouping is acting as the voice of the global start-up ecosystem, bringing together varied stakeholders on a common platform. It aspires to create a global narrative for start-ups and enabling synergies with corporates, investors, innovation agencies and other key stakeholders. We

> "UNDER INDIA'S LEADERSHIP, WE ESTABLISHED THE STARTUP20 ENGAGEMENT GROUP, **A FIRST-OF-ITS-KIND INITIATIVE UNDER THE G20**. THEY WILL ACT AS THE VOICE OF THE GLOBAL START-UP ECOSYSTEM"